



Joanne Garlich, MS LPCC

5/28/2026

Dr. Buckley  
M Health Fairview Plastic and Reconstructive Surgery Clinic  
909 Fulton Street Southeast  
Minneapolis, MN 55455  
Fax: 612-676-5036

RE: J. Johnson (DOB 1/13/1985)

Dear Dr. Buckley,

I am writing in regards to our shared client, J. Johnson, who is a 41 year old, Euro American non binary trans masculine person who uses they/them pronouns. J has asked me to write a letter of support for their request to have double mastectomy surgery in order to masculinize their body. I have worked with J for 28 individual therapy sessions since May of 2025.

I am a psychotherapist practicing as a licensed professional clinical counselor with competence to diagnose and treat gender nonconforming identities and expressions as well as comorbid disorders. I have a specialty in working with transgender and gender nonconforming clients and consult with medical and mental health professionals in the area of transgender healthcare.

J did not realize top surgery was an option until a friend underwent the procedure 10 years ago. They have been planning on getting top surgery since that time, though waited until they moved to MN, a much less conservative state. J stated their current chest does not feel true to who they are in their gender. J has noted that the gender dysphoria about this area of their body has continued to increase over time and is currently causing distress to the point where J is seeking double mastectomy surgery. Due to the significant level of gender dysphoria caused by their current chest, chest surgery is a medical necessity and as such, should be covered by their medical insurance plan.

I have assessed J's ability to make informed decisions about their body and believe they fully understand the benefits and risks of chest surgery in order to meet their goal of increasing the congruence between their masculine identification and physical body. Furthermore, J has been following the World Professional Association of Transgender Health's recommended criteria for this procedure.

joannegarlichtherapy.com  
615 W. 35th St. Mpls, MN 55408/ 651-968-7822/ 949-258-0567 fax  
joannegarlich@ptpmn.org



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The following are the recommended criteria they have met:

1. J has persistent, well documented gender dysphoria;
2. J has the capacity to make a fully informed decision and to consent for treatment;
3. J is a legal adult;
4. J is currently diagnosed with anxiety, which is well managed with therapy. Furthermore, it is expected that J's mental health will only continue to improve with the requested surgery.

I have attached a signed authorization to release information. Please feel free to contact me for further information or to coordinate care.

Sincerely,

Joanne Garlich, MS LPCC